

What types of boxes can be included in a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram or outcomes framework?

There is significant confusion about the features of the types of boxes that can be included in strategy/outcomes diagrams and outcomes frameworks. This Features of Boxes That Can Be Included In A DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram or Outcomes Framework Tool (B9) clarifies this. From a conceptual point of view, the tool also provides an unambiguous way of tightly defining things such as 'outcomes' 'goals' 'results' 'objectives' as they are being used in a different setting. Outcomes work is current characterized by 'terminological madness' as people talk past each other with different definitions of the terms they are using. This tool eliminates this.

The tool provides a list of the features of boxes that can potentially be included within a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram or outcomes framework.

Often purchasers/funders ask suppliers/providers to: 'give us a list of your 'deliverables', 'outputs', 'goals', 'outcomes', 'impacts' or other elements.

Just requesting such a list in this way relies on both parties having a clear technical understanding of precisely what is being asked for. For example, what exactly is meant by a 'deliverable', 'output', 'goal', 'outcome' or 'impact'?

There is a reasonable level of understanding of some of these terms. In particular, the term 'output' is widely understood as 'goods or services produced by an organization or initiative'. However, as is illustrated in the Defining An Initiative's Outcomes Explainer (B14) there can be serious disagreement about what exactly is meant by terms such as an initiative's 'outcomes' 'goals' etc.

This tool allows a purchaser/funder or supplier/provider to tightly define any term they want to use. Using the tool they do this by specifying the features they want the box in the DoView to have which are listed in the tool. They just need to list the features they are wanting when they refer to any particular element such as a 'outcome', 'impact' etc.